

**Special Notice (SN) DARPA-SN-26-70**  
**Expeditionary Power- and Energy-Dense Implementations (ExPEDitions)**  
**Proposers Day**  
**May 14, 2026**

The Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA) Defense Sciences Office (DSO) is sponsoring a Proposers Day to provide information to potential proposers on the objectives of an anticipated Program Solicitation (PS) for the Expeditionary Power- and Energy-Dense Implementations (ExPEDitions) program. The Proposers Day will be held on May 14, 2026, from 12:00 p.m. (noon) to 4:00 p.m. (Eastern Time) in Arlington, VA. The event will be webcast for those who would like to participate remotely. Advance registration is required for attending the Proposers Day in person and viewing the webcast. Note that all times listed in this announcement and on the registration website are Eastern Time.

The goals of the ExPEDitions Proposers Day are to: (1) introduce the research community (industry, academia, and Government) to the ExPEDitions program vision and goals; (2) explain the mechanics of a DARPA program and the milestones of this particular effort; and (3) encourage and promote teaming arrangements among potential organizations that have the relevant expertise, facilities, and capabilities for executing a research and development program responsive to the ExPEDitions program goals.

DARPA anticipates releasing the ExPEDitions PS in May 2026. If released, the PS will be available on <https://sam.gov/> Following Proposers Day, DARPA may post the presented materials on the DARPA website.

To maximize the pool of innovative proposal concepts, DARPA strongly encourages participation by non-traditional proposers (including small businesses, academic and research institutions, and first-time Government contractors) in events such as this and any subsequent solicitation.

#### **PROGRAM OBJECTIVE AND DESCRIPTION**

DARPA DSO is pursuing foundational technology for electrically rechargeable batteries with high energy and power density. While current state-of-the-art batteries enable efficient and quiet operations, their low energy density makes them too large and heavy for long-range missions or weight-sensitive applications like electric aviation, necessitating the continued use of fuel for these missions, which complicates logistics.

Recent breakthroughs in electrocatalysis, battery design, and materials science may overcome long-standing technical hurdles with sluggish reaction kinetics and mass transport limitations.<sup>1,2,3,4</sup> This new approach will extend the operational range and endurance of missions and free portable energy from the constraint of fuel logistics. ExPEDitions performers will drive this initiative by designing advanced battery prototypes and integrating them into demonstrator devices to prove the technology's ability to extend mission endurance.

#### **TEAMING**

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<sup>1</sup> Kondori et al. *Science*, **2023**, 379, 499-505.

<sup>2</sup> Zhou et al. *Nat. Commun.*, **2022**, 13, 6414.

<sup>3</sup> Wang et al. *Proc. Natl. Acad. Sci.* **2025**, 122, e2413609122.

<sup>4</sup> Anson & Stahl *Chem. Rev.*, **2020**, 120, 3749–3786.

DARPA highly encourages teaming before proposal submission and will facilitate the formation of teams with the necessary expertise. Potential proposers may choose to participate in either, none, or both of the following options:

1. **Attendee List (limited distribution):** Participant contact information (name, organization, email address) will be distributed to all other ExPEDitions Proposers Day attendees. The registration website will ask registrants to indicate whether they approve distribution of their contact information.
2. **Proposer Profile List (limited distribution):** Interested parties will submit a one-page profile consisting of their contact information (name, organization, email, telephone number, mailing address, and, if applicable, organization website), a brief description of their technical competencies, and, if applicable, their desired expertise from other teams/organizations. All profiles must be emailed to [ExPEDitions@darpa.mil](mailto:ExPEDitions@darpa.mil) no later than 12:00 p.m. (noon) on May 18, 2026. Following the deadline, the consolidated teaming profiles will be sent via email to the proposers who submitted a valid profile. Specific content, communications, networking, and team formation are the sole responsibility of the participants. Neither DARPA nor the Department of War (DoW) endorses the information and organizations contained in the consolidated teaming profile document, nor does DARPA or DoW exercise any responsibility for improper dissemination of the teaming profiles.

## **LIGHTNING TALKS**

Attendees may be afforded the opportunity to give a Lightning Talk (a brief, 5-minute oral presentation) during the webcast outlining their interests and capabilities. The purpose of these presentations is to facilitate teaming discussions among the attendees. Upon registering, attendees may indicate if they would like to give a Lightning Talk. Due to limited availability, DARPA will accept submissions on a first-come, first-served basis and does not guarantee that an attendee's requests to brief will be fulfilled. Submitted briefing materials should use the template provided via the registration website and are limited to a single, PDF-format slide, which should be appropriate for public release, as they will be shared with the session via webcast. The slide must be submitted to [ExPEDitions@darpa.mil](mailto:ExPEDitions@darpa.mil) by 12:00 p.m. (noon) on May 12, 2026. DARPA will contact submitters upon receipt of their slide with additional guidance for the webcast.

## **REGISTRATION INFORMATION**

The ExPEDitions Proposers Day will be held on May 14, 2026, from 12:00 p.m. (noon) to 4:00 p.m. in Arlington, VA. There is no registration fee for the Proposers Day meeting or webcast.

**Registration opens:** As of publication of this announcement.

**Registration website:** <https://events.sa-meetings.com/ExPEDitionsProposersDay>

**Registration closes (in person attendance):** May 4, 2026, at 5:00 p.m. or when capacity is reached, whichever comes first.

**Registration closes (webcast):** May 4, 2026, at 5:00 p.m. or when capacity is reached, whichever comes first.

Advance registration via the above website is required for attending the Proposers Day in person and for receiving access to the webcast. The advance registration requirement applies

to every individual intending to view the webcast alone or as part of a group.

Due to the limitations of the conference facility space, in-person attendance is restricted to the first 100 registrants with a maximum of five (5) individuals from any one organization and no more than two (2) representatives per division/department of that organization. Interested parties are encouraged to coordinate attendance internally within their organizations prior to registration.

Registrants in excess of the maximum capacity limitations (100 individuals for in-person attendance and 350 individuals for the webcast) may be added to a waitlist. Individuals who are unable to register for in-person attendance because capacity has been reached may have the option of choosing to be added to the waitlist OR registering for attendance via webcast. If slots become available due to cancellations, the slots may be filled on a first-come, first-served basis from the waitlist.

## **ELIGIBILITY**

DARPA hosts Proposers Days to: (1) promote teaming arrangements between researchers, (2) provide potential proposers with information on whether and how they might respond to the Government's research and development solicitations, and (3) increase efficiency in proposal preparation and evaluation. Therefore, Proposers Days are only open to registered potential proposers, i.e., the events are closed to the general public and media. For this particular program, Proposers Day registration is open to potential proposers who are U.S. citizens, U.S. permanent residents, and foreign nationals.

All registrants who are not U.S. citizens must complete and submit either a DARPA Form 60 (U.S. Permanent Resident and Foreign National Visit Request – e.g., industry or academia) or an Official Visit Request (foreign government personnel, only) through their country's embassy based in Washington, DC, no later than 5:00 p.m. on May 4, 2026. Form 60 submission instructions are provided on the registration website and in the registration confirmation email. Registrants who have submitted a Form 60 that was approved within the last six months do not need to re-submit. The Form 60 will remain valid for six months. Contact your Embassy staff for assistance in submitting the Official Visit Request. Upon entry to the physical meeting, all attendees must present valid, Government-issued photo identification.

## **Q & A**

Administrative, technical, and contractual questions about ExPEDitions should be emailed to [ExPEDitions@darpa.mil](mailto:ExPEDitions@darpa.mil). All questions must be in English and must include the name and email address of a point of contact. Following Proposers Day, DARPA may post an FAQ list on the DARPA website.

## **CONTACT INFORMATION**

Please refer to ExPEDitions Proposers Day in all correspondence.

- Technical Point of Contact: Keith Whitener, Program Manager, [ExPEDitions@darpa.mil](mailto:ExPEDitions@darpa.mil)
- Registration Website: <https://events.sa-meetings.com/ExPEDitionsProposersDay>
- DARPA Opportunities Website: <https://www.darpa.mil/research#research-opportunities>

## **DISCLAIMERS AND IMPORTANT NOTES**

Attendance at the ExPEDitions Proposers Day or viewing the webcast is voluntary and is not required to propose to the anticipated ExPEDitions PS. Interested parties to this notice are cautioned that nothing herein obligates the Government to issue a solicitation. The Proposers Day does not constitute a formal solicitation for proposals or abstracts. This announcement is issued solely for information and program planning purposes and is not a Request for Information (RFI). Since this is not an RFI, the Government will not accept submissions against this notice, with the exception of the one-page profile referenced in the Teaming section above and briefing materials associated with Lightning Talks. No classified, International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR) controlled, or proprietary information shall be presented by the Government at Proposers Day. Inclusion of proprietary information during Lightning Talks is at the presenter's discretion; however, any submitted Lightning Talk presentation slides should be appropriate for public release. DARPA will not provide reimbursement for costs incurred to participate in this Proposers Day. Recording Proposers Day is not permitted.

For those new to DARPA or national security, DARPA makes available a free, comprehensive resource via DARPACONnect on how to do business with the agency. In addition to DARPA 101 materials, relevant preparatory modules include "Making the Most of a Proposers Day" and "Understanding DARPA Broad Agency Announcements." Registration and access are free at [www.darpaconnect.us](http://www.darpaconnect.us).